



Unit 8

YOUTH

1. Vocabulary for speaking: Childhood

Childhood activities (Các hoạt động thời thơ ấu)

1. **blow bubbles:** thổi bong bóng xà phòng
2. **build sand castle:** xây lâu đài cát
3. **chew gum and blow bubbles:** nhai kẹo cao su và thổi bong bóng
4. **climb trees:** trèo cây
5. **dress like a superhero:** mặc như siêu nhân
6. **eat cotton candies:** ăn kẹo bông
7. **fight with other kids:** oánh nhau với bọn trẻ con khác
8. **fly kites:** thả diều
9. **fly paper planes:** chơi máy bay giấy
10. **get hurt:** bị (ngã) đau
11. **handle disgusting animals:** chơi với những con vật rất kinh (Ví dụ: nghịch sâu róm)
12. **have a pet:** được bố mẹ cho nuôi thú cưng (chó/ mèo/ gà con/ vịt con)
13. **jump:** nhảy
14. **jump rope:** nhảy dây
15. **plant trees:** trồng cây
16. **play hide-and-seek:** chơi trốn tìm
17. **play hopscotch:** nhảy lò cò
18. **play with a slingshot:** bắn súng cao su
19. **play with building blocks:** chơi xếp gạch, chơi xếp hộp hoặc các thứ chồng lên nhau
20. **play with dolls:** chơi búp bê
21. **play with pinwheels:** chơi chong chóng
22. **play with yo-yos:** chơi con quay yo-yo
23. **ride a bicycle:** tập đi xe đạp và bắt đầu biết đi xe đạp
24. **ride the see-saw:** chơi bập bênh
25. **rollerblade:** trượt patin
26. **save money in a piggy bank:** bỏ lợn tiết kiệm
27. **slide:** chơi cầu trượt
28. **step on puddle:** nhảy trong vũng nước bẩn
29. **suck my thumb:** mút tay
30. **swing:** ngồi xích đu
31. **swing the hula hoop:** lắc vòng

32. **tickle others:** *cù nhau*

33. **wear my older brother's/ sister's clothes:** *mặc quần áo của anh/ chị*

Words & short phrases about 'Childhood' (Các từ và cụm từ ngắn về 'Thời thơ ấu')

34. **adolescence = teenage years** (từ đồng nghĩa là **puberty**) /ˌæd.əˈles.əns/: the period of life between childhood and adulthood → *tuổi dậy thì*

- *She had a troubled adolescence.*

35. **bring up:** to care for a child until it is an adult → *nuôi nấng*

36. **childhood** (n.) /ˈtʃaɪld.hʊd/: the time when someone is a child → *thời thơ ấu*

- *My childhood was spent moving from place to place as my father was in the army.*

37. **experience** (v.) /ɪkˈspɪə.ri.əns/: If you experience something, it happens to you, or you feel it → *trải nghiệm*

- *New companies often experience a loss in their first few years.*

38. **experience** (n.) /ɪkˈspɪə.ri.əns/: something that happens to you that affects how you feel; the way that something happens and how it makes you feel → *kinh nghiệm, sự trải nghiệm*

- *Fighting in Vietnam was an experience that would haunt him for the rest of his life.*

39. **grow up** (v.): to change from being a child to being an adult → *lớn lên*

- *She grew up on a Pennsylvania farm.*

40. **mature** (adj.) /məˈtʃʊər/: completely grown physically; mature people behave like adults in a way that shows they are well developed emotionally → *chín chắn, trưởng thành*

- *He's very mature for his age.*

41. **memory** (n.) /ˈmem.ər.i/: something that you remember from the past → *kỷ niệm*

- *I have vivid memories of that evening.*

42. **peer** (n.) /piər/: a person who is the same age or has the same social position or the same abilities as other people in a group → *bạn cùng trang lứa; bạn cùng ngành*

- *Do you think it's true that teenage girls are less self-confident than their male peers?*

43. **remind** (v.): to make someone think of something they have forgotten or might have forgotten → *làm gợi nhớ đến*

- *Every time we meet he reminds me about the money he lent me.*

44. **rural** (adj.) /ˈrʊə.rəl/: in, of, or like the countryside → *nông thôn*

- *The area is still very rural and undeveloped.*

45. **take care** (v.): to protect someone or something and provide the things that that person or thing needs → *chăm sóc*

- *Don't worry about me, I can take care of myself (= I do not need anyone else to protect me).*

46. **upbringing** (n.): the way in which you are treated and educated when young, especially by your parents, especially in relation to the effect that this has on how you behave and make moral decisions → *sự nuôi dưỡng*

47. **vast** (adj.): extremely big or large → *bao la, rộng lớn*

- *The vast majority of our students – nearly 90 percent – graduate within four years.*

Long phrases & expressions about 'Childhood' (Các cụm từ dài về 'Thời thơ ấu')

48. **assert your independence/individuality:** khẳng định sự độc lập/cái tôi cá nhân
49. **bamboo** /ˌbæmˈbuː/: *tre*
50. **be born and raised in Ho Chi Minh City:** sinh ra và lớn lên ở TP.HCM
51. **be born and raised into a wealthy/middle-class/poor family:** sinh ra và lớn lên trong một gia đình giàu có/ trung lưu/ nghèo
52. **be an only child** (with no brothers or sisters): *là con một* (không có anh/chị em)
53. **be in your teens/ early twenties/ mid-twenties/ late twenties:** ở tuổi thiếu niên/ khoảng 20/ khoảng 25/ gần 30
54. **benefit from:** có được lợi ích từ (việc gì đó)
55. **buddy** /ˈbʌdi/: *bạn thân*
56. **carefree childhood:** *tuổi thơ êm đềm*
57. **chase after:** *đuổi theo*
58. **definitely** /ˈdefɪnətli/: *chắc chắn*
59. **formative years:** *năm tháng hình thành, phát triển*
60. **grow up on a farm:** *lớn lên trên một nông trại*
61. **grow up in a musical family/ an orphanage:** *lớn lên trong một gia đình âm nhạc/ở cô nhi viện*
62. **have a happy/ an unhappy/ a tough childhood:** *có một tuổi thơ hạnh phúc/ bất hạnh/ khó nhọc*
63. **have good manners:** *có cách cư xử tốt*
64. **immerse myself into:** *hòa mình*
65. **lasting impression:** *điều gì đó ảnh hưởng sâu sắc đến bạn*
66. **make it up:** *làm hòa*
67. **neighboring:** *gần, hàng xóm*
68. **peer pressure:** *áp lực từ bạn bè cùng trang lứa*
69. **playmates:** *bạn cùng chơi*
70. **reach/ hit/ enter/ go through adolescence/puberty:** *đến tuổi thiếu niên/dậy thì*
71. **scared of:** *sợ*
72. **shortly after:** *rất nhanh sau đó*
73. **stable upbringing:** *sự nuôi dưỡng ổn định trong môi trường tốt*
74. **take me back:** *làm cho tôi nhớ lại một cái gì đó từ quá khứ*
75. **undergo/experience physical/psychological changes:** *trải qua những thay đổi cơ thể/tâm lý*
76. **unforgettable:** *không thể quên được*

2. IELTS Speaking Part 1: Introduction & Interview

1. Did you enjoy your childhood? Why or why not?

→ Yes, definitely. I had lots of fun playing traditional games with my neighboring kids. And besides, I also had a stable upbringing thanks to my parents.

(Vâng, chắc chắn rồi. Tôi đã có rất nhiều niềm vui khi chơi các trò chơi truyền thống với những đứa trẻ hàng xóm. Và ngoài ra, tôi cũng đã có một sự nuôi nấng đầy đủ từ ba mẹ mình.)

→ Yes, without a doubt. Childhood memories are unforgettable and in these formative years, stable upbringing by my parents also shape who I am today. I am so thankful for that!

(Có, đương nhiên rồi. Ký ức ấu thơ là không thể quên được và trong những năm tháng dậy thì, sự nuôi dạy tốt từ bố mẹ đã hình thành nên con người tôi ngày hôm nay. Tôi rất biết ơn vì điều đó!)

→ Everybody has childhood memories and among them some are pleasant and some are sad. For me, I suppose my childhood time very magical and pleasant when I remember laughing a lot and spending lots of time together with my family, in spite of many ups and downs in the prime of my life that I didn't realise.

(Mọi người đều có những ký ức thời thơ ấu và trong số đó một số là vui vẻ và một số là buồn. Đối với tôi, tôi cho rằng thời gian tuổi thơ của tôi rất huyền diệu và dễ chịu khi tôi nhớ tôi cười rất nhiều và dành rất nhiều thời gian cho gia đình, mặc cho có nhiều thăng trầm trong những năm đầu đời cuộc sống của tôi mà tôi đã không nhận ra.)

2. What activities did you enjoy doing as a child?

→ When I was a child, I was interested in playing football with my friends and brother. In addition, I was also a big fan of video games and children books.

(Khi tôi còn là một đứa trẻ, tôi thích chơi đá banh với bạn bè và anh trai. Ngoài ra, tôi còn rất thích trò chơi điện tử và truyện dành cho trẻ em.)

→ Well, many things, including playing games, making toys, and especially bathing in the river nearby. I was never allowed to get close to the river, but, you know, kids like water.

(Ồ, rất nhiều thứ, bao gồm chơi trò chơi, làm đồ chơi, và đặc biệt là tắm sông ở con sông gần nhà. Tôi chưa bao giờ được cho phép lại gần con sông, nhưng bạn biết đấy, trẻ con đều thích nước.)

→ I love cycling when I was a child. Cycling gave me the sense that I was free, that there was nothing that could stop me and I could just live the life as I want to and it was this feeling that made me love cycling even more. I remember, cycling during holidays and then evenings, even in the morning. I just loved it.

3. What was your favorite toy when you were a child?

→ Hmm... Let me think... I was really into dinosaurs when I was a child, I suppose my favourite toy would have been a dinosaur. Honestly, though, I can't remember that much.

(Hmm... Hãy để tôi nghĩ rằng tôi thực sự thích khủng long khi tôi còn nhỏ, tôi cho rằng đồ chơi yêu thích của tôi sẽ là một con khủng long. Thành thật mà nói, tôi không thể nhớ được nhiều như vậy.)

→ When I was young, I loved my teddy more than any other toy. Whenever I felt sad, I would just talk to him. He was really a shoulder to cry on. If I needed comfort, I would hug him and cry, and I would feel better afterward.

(Khi tôi còn nhỏ, tôi yêu thú bông của mình hơn bất kỳ món đồ chơi nào khác. Bất cứ khi nào tôi cảm thấy buồn, tôi sẽ chỉ nói chuyện với nó. Nó thực sự là người tôi tìm đến để dựa dẫm. Nếu tôi cần được an ủi, tôi sẽ ôm nó và khóc, và tôi sẽ cảm thấy ổn hơn.)

→ Our childhood favorite toy was a bubble blowing machine. Actually, it was a total impulse buy when my family went shopping at the supermarket. It turned out to be a huge hit as my siblings and I were really into it.

(Đồ chơi yêu thích thời thơ ấu của chúng tôi là một chiếc máy thổi bong bóng. Thực ra, đó là một món đồ mua vội khi gia đình tôi đi mua sắm ở siêu thị. Nó hóa ra lại là một món đồ tuyệt vời khi anh chị em tôi và tôi thực sự thích nó.)

4. What's your most vivid childhood memory?

→ Well, many but the moment when my friends and I chased after a dog and nearly got attacked by it is what I remember most. We were not allowed to come near that fierce dog but kids are scared of nothing you know. However, after running so hard to avoid the dog, we never did that again even when allowed.

(Thú thực thì có rất nhiều nhưng khoảnh khắc tôi và những người bạn đuổi theo con chó và gần như bị cắn bởi nó là điều tôi nhớ nhất. Chúng tôi không được phép lại gần chú chó hung dữ đó nhưng trẻ con mà, có biết sợ là gì đâu. Tuy nhiên, sau khi chạy thừa sức để tránh chú chó, chúng tôi không bao giờ dám làm thế nữa, ngay cả khi được cho phép.)

→ I remember going out walking with my friends one day. We often used to go walking in the countryside near my home, and this time we walked really far over the fields. It started to rain really heavily, so we hid under a big tree, but then there was a thunderstorm, and you really shouldn't stay under a tree when there's lightning. It was really scary.

(Tôi nhớ một ngày đi dạo với bạn bè. Chúng tôi thường đi dạo ở vùng quê gần nhà, và lần này chúng tôi đi bộ rất xa trên cánh đồng. Trời bắt đầu mưa rất to, vì vậy chúng tôi trốn dưới một cái cây lớn, nhưng sau đó có giông bão và bạn thực sự không nên ở dưới gốc cây khi có sét. Nó thật sự đáng sợ.)

→ I have various childhood memories and I daresay that I would like to hang on to old memory related to my school time, exactly my first day at school. In my very first imagination, school would be a great time and I would have lots of friends and I would study there. However, I turned out to be frightened for few moments and sat at a corner of the class. I was so reserved that I was unable to introduce myself when asked.

(Tôi có vài kỷ niệm thời thơ ấu khác nhau và tôi dám nói rằng tôi muốn suy nghĩ về những kỷ niệm thời đi học, chính xác là ngày đầu tiên của tôi ở trường. Trong trí tưởng tượng đầu tiên của tôi, trường học sẽ là nơi tuyệt vời và tôi sẽ có rất nhiều bạn bè và tôi sẽ học tập ở đó. Tuy nhiên, hóa ra tôi lại lo sợ cho vài phút và ngồi vào một góc của lớp. Tôi đã rất nhút nhát đến nỗi mà tôi không thể giới thiệu bản thân mình khi được hỏi.)

5. Are you still in touch with your childhood friends?

→ Not really, no. We drifted apart over the years. I still get together with my best friend from primary school maybe once every year or two, but that's all. I suppose I see what people are up to on Facebook.

(Không thực sự, không. Chúng tôi dần xa cách qua nhiều năm. Tôi vẫn gặp bạn thân từ thời tiểu học có thể một hoặc hai năm một lần, nhưng chỉ thế thôi. Tôi cho rằng tôi thấy những gì mọi người đang làm trên Facebook.)

→ Yes, I do, but definitely only the closest friends of mine. I have three childhood friends whom I consider for keeps. Two of them move out of our country, one is living in the US and the other one is in New Zealand while the other one is living in my neighboring town. Well, we all have our own family now however we make sure to update each other every now and then.

→ Not at all! Unfortunately, I wasn't able to make great friends during my childhood days, though I did have some friends. Besides, my family moved to the countryside from a city when I finished primary school so I didn't have any chance to meet them again and ask for their contact information.

6. Who did you spend more time with when you were a child, your friends or your family?

→ In my early years, I spent more time with my family than with my friends. My parents, my brother and I often went shopping together. Furthermore, we also enjoyed watching movies and travelling together.

7. How have you changed since you were a child?

→ Since I was a child, I have developed various life skills. For example, I have been better at time management, planning and public speaking skills. In addition, I have also learnt to appreciate the value of hard work and determination, when it comes to achieving big objectives.

→ Yes, I think that I change completely. From a shy, introverted child who was scared of everything, after experiencing, learning and growing a lot, now, I can confidently claim that I am a social butterfly. Knowing my own strength and weaknesses, I can be more confident and amiable.

→ My behavior and attitude have, without a doubt, changed since I was younger. When I was younger, my behavior and attitude, was that of someone seeking approval, so I was always careful to take the appropriate action, usually with a lot of pre-thought, to behave with the attitude that I thought was expected of me. Now I have started to focus on things that really matter – my family, friends and my future. I am working hard towards my goal.

8. What about your childhood do you wish you could change?

→ If ever I could change one thing about my childhood, it would be my relation with my brother. For some reasons, I think we as children, never talked to each other much and it was later in life that I came to know that we both were two lonely souls and could have stuck together and enjoyed life as we grew up.

3. IELTS Speaking Part 2: Individual long-turn talk

Topic: **Describe a happy childhood memory.**

You should say:

- when and where the incident you remember happened
- who you were with
- what happened exactly

and explain why it is a happy memory.



When I was about eight years old, my family took a trip to a beach on the other side of the country. It was a small holiday resort that we sometimes visited. We stayed in a caravan (*xe có nhà lưu động*) near this beautiful horse-shoe shaped beach, and all day I'd play in the sand. Most of the time we were together. We would play games on the beach and have picnics, although it was too cold to ever go swimming. Sometimes I would play on my own. I loved looking in rock pools (*hồ đá, hồ thủy triều*) for fish and crabs. On one occasion, I caught loads of crabs in my bucket and when it was time to go back to the caravan at the end of the day, my mum and dad told me I should put the crabs back into the water. I was so upset. However, they eventually convinced me that if I kept them then they'd die and so it was best to put them back. I always look back on that time fondly. Those were wonderful, carefree days with my family, and I learned an important lesson that day that has served me well in life.

(IELTS Band score: 6.0)

Model answer 2:

Every summer I would go back to my hometown to stay with my grandparents, cousins, aunts and uncles, while my parents continued working. I used to really enjoy spending time with them.

One day - it must be about 20 years ago - all of us got really, really bored. Suddenly, my granddad came up with the idea of going to a new water park that had opened that summer. I hadn't heard about it but my cousins had, and they told me all about it. We were so excited.

We set off and on the way we were all singing songs and laughing. We couldn't wait to get there. When we arrived, my cousins and I ran into the park and changed into our swimming costumes. We played all day in the park and had a lovely lunch, sat on some benches in the sunshine.

My granddad loved a pool that was filled with spa water. It was dark brown and stank of rotten eggs. I didn't want to go in but he eventually convinced me. I'm pleased he did because the water was really warm. I'd never swam in water that warm. I didn't want to get out, despite the terrible smell.

I consider it such a happy memory because we enjoyed ourselves so much and I remember so vividly how I felt that day. But there's more to it than just that. When I look back now, I understand how caring my grandparents were and how much they wanted us all to be happy.

So, as you can see, it was a wonderful day and is one of my favourite childhood memories.

(IELTS Band score: 7.0+)

4. IELTS Speaking Part 3: Discussion

CHILDHOOD

1. Is it important for children to have fun? Why?

→ Well, yes, of course. As you get older, life tends to get more and more stressful. There are so many social and economic pressures that trouble us, so I think people should be allowed to enjoy their childhoods. I mean, just look at children. They are so innocent and carefree by their nature. Let them have fun.

(Vâng, vâng, tất nhiên. Khi bạn già đi, cuộc sống có xu hướng ngày càng căng thẳng. Có rất nhiều áp lực kinh tế và xã hội gây rắc rối cho chúng tôi, vì vậy tôi nghĩ mọi người nên được phép tận hưởng tuổi thơ của mình. Ý tôi là, chỉ cần nhìn vào trẻ em. Chúng rất hồn nhiên và vô tư bởi bản chất của chúng. Hãy để chúng vui vẻ.)

→ It is important because I believe children learn a lot through play. They learn about the world around them, they learn how to interact with other people, they learn about possible dangers through acting them out. Children shouldn't be made to grow up too fast, they should be allowed to experience the world of make-believe first. They spend long enough in the real world as adults.

2. What do you think is the most important for a happy childhood?

→ The most important thing for a happy childhood is a happy home. It is very important for a child to grow as a happy individual to have a home where his/her parents love each other. Where, there is a balance in life.

3. How does a person's childhood influence what kind of adult they become?

→ Well, it probably influences them in many ways, some of which are subtle and some obvious. For one example, if you have a happy, healthy childhood, you are probably more likely to become a well-adjusted adult. However, if you were subjected to bullying and abuse, you may replicate that behaviour as an adult.

(Vâng, nó có thể ảnh hưởng đến họ theo nhiều cách, một số trong đó là tinh tế và một số rõ ràng. Một ví dụ, nếu bạn có một tuổi thơ hạnh phúc, khỏe mạnh, có lẽ bạn có nhiều khả năng trở thành một người trưởng thành được điều chỉnh tốt. Tuy nhiên, nếu bạn bị bắt nạt và lạm dụng, bạn có thể sao chép hành vi đó khi trưởng thành.)

→ Well, I suppose the adult you become is influenced by three main factors: firstly, your childhood, that is 'nurture'; then, your genes, that is 'nature'; and last but not least, the choices you make as an adult. To my mind, of all three, nurture has the greatest impact. They've conducted research on twins who were separated at birth and, while there are undoubtedly many similarities between them, they are also very different in many key ways: their success in the world of work, their relationships with other people. I think all this is influenced by the role models we have throughout our childhoods.

4. When does a child become an adult in your view?

→ Oh wow, that's a difficult question. I suppose legally we are adults at 18 in my country. However, I think growing into adulthood is more complex and inexact process. Some people

mature very early and others very late, and there is probably no point at which any person could be said to have switched from childhood to adulthood.

(Ồ wow, đó là một câu hỏi khó. Tôi cho rằng về mặt pháp lý chúng tôi là người lớn ở tuổi 18 ở đất nước tôi. Tuy nhiên, tôi nghĩ rằng việc trưởng thành vào tuổi trưởng thành là quá trình phức tạp và không chính xác. Một số người trưởng thành rất sớm và những người khác rất muộn, và có lẽ không có điểm nào mà bất kỳ người nào có thể nói là đã chuyển từ thời thơ ấu sang tuổi trưởng thành.)

→ That's a difficult question to answer and all societies grapple with this issue. It is, of course, critical for the criminal justice system to define an 'adult' correctly, or at least try to, because if somebody commits a crime as a child, they get treated more leniently than if they commit a crime as an adult. So I suppose you have to decide when you think people become fully responsible for their actions. I wouldn't want to be the one making that decision. I just don't know.

UPBRINGING

5. Do you agree with the saying "children should be seen and not heard"?

→ I'm assuming this means that children should respect their elders and not create havoc by being noisy and answering adults back. I have some sympathy with this view. However, moderation is usually the best course to take in all things, as with upbringing. Children should respect their elders, which involves doing as they're told. Too many children nowadays think they run the household, making demands, etc. However, it is also true that a child is part of the family, too and also deserves respect. I think this means they should be allowed to express their points of view and they should be listened to and consulted. It's a fine balance, I suppose.

6. Is it good for children to be exposed to frightening and sad experiences or should they be protected from these as far as possible?

→ I don't think they should experience too many sad or terrifying experiences, if it can be helped. Nevertheless, what is very useful for teaching children about these darker sides of life without scarring them is stories. In stories they can learn about evil and the dangers in the world around them, but in a controlled way where the 'baddies' are punished and everyone ends up happy. This gives them a focus for the fears that all children have but it is a fictional one so doesn't upset their peace of mind.

7. Are children in your country generally well brought up?

→ My instinct is to say 'no' because you see many misbehaving children when you're out and about. In reality, there are probably many more well brought up children than badly brought up ones, it's just that the good children don't attract your attention as much.